

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« These two continue to push each other to new levels. Their serves improve, their forehands improve, their movement improves and their mentality improves. – International Tennis Federation CEO Ross Hutchins on the ever-growing 'Sincaraz' rivalry »



« I hope to keep pushing it. I hope to keep irritating everyone who has to vote for me for years to come. It's really important for me to win this for the field eventers. – Sweden's Armand Duplantis who was named World Athlete of the Year by World Athletics »

1st

Ayub Bliev became the first Russian judoka in more than two years to win a title under his national flag when he triumphed at the Abu Dhabi Grand Slam tournament. Bliev, 28, beat Mongolia's Ariunbold Enkhtaivan in the

60kg final and received his gold medal with his national flag being raised and the Russian anthem played. Bliev and his compatriots had their neutral athlete status lifted by the International Judo Federation (IJF), which had been in place since Russia invaded Ukraine in February 2022.



3rd

Italy captured a remarkable third consecutive Davis Cup title with Matteo Berrettini and Flavio Cobolli winning their singles matches for a 2-0 triumph over Spain in the best-of-three tie in Bologna. Berrettini dispatched Pablo Carreno Busta 6-3, 6-4 in the opening match before Cobolli overcame Jaume Munar 1-6, 7-6[5], 7-5 to seal the triumph for Filippo Volandri's team.

ON TOP OF THE WORLD



India clinched the Women's Kabaddi World Cup in Dhaka, defeating Chinese Taipei 35-28 in the final to secure a second straight title. India maintained an unbeaten run through the tournament and beat Iran 33-21 in the semifinal. Chinese Taipei also entered the final without a loss, overcoming host Bangladesh 25-18 in the last four. ANI